

Narrative Medicine	
MODULE OVERVIEW	
Grade 12 CTE	
Module Type	Issue
Length of Instructional Time	3 weeks
Module Summary	This module aims to develop students’ ability to listen with the purpose of understanding, synthesize multiple perspectives, and craft cohesive and compelling narratives. Drawing on the idea of “narrative medicine,” or the application of storytelling to health-care practices, this module guides students in exploring the communicative and therapeutic purposes served by narrative ideas and strategies. The defining feature of this module is its emphasis on active and empathic listening. The instructional activities give special attention to oral and interpersonal communication, and, in particular, to storytelling as a best practice in the field of health care. Activities offer students extended practice listening with the purpose of understanding. The module is further distinguished by its focus on Career Technical Education (CTE) and by its culminating Interview and Story Project.
Questions at Issue	• To what extent do empathic listening and narrative competence contribute to effective health care? • How can emphatic listening skills be used to understand and create stories?
Module Text	Charon, Rita. “Narrative and Medicine.” <i>New England Journal of Medicine</i>, vol. 350, no. 9, 26 Feb. 2004, pp. 862-864, www.nejm.org/doi/full/10.1056/NEJMp038249. ▪ This nonfiction text explains the concept of practicing medicine with “narrative competence” and really listening to the stories patients tell to learn more about their medical condition rather than relying solely on clinical evaluation. ▪ In addition, module includes a video text from the World Science Festival about the value of emphatic listening in the medical world.
Culminating Task	The culminating task for this module is the Interview and Story Project. Students first practice and apply their skills in dialogic communication by conducting research, developing a set of interview questions, and then interviewing a person (or viewing a recorded interview). During the interview, students will take notes on the content, form, and emotion of the interviewee’s responses. Students then use these notes to write a two- to three-page narrative in response to the interview demonstrating their ability to listen empathically. Students may interweave one of their own personal stories into their description of the speaker’s experience as appropriate.

Rhetorical Concepts	• Perspective • Dialogue • Pathos
Objectives	Integrated ELD: • Develop interview questions • Practice empathic listening (i.e., listening for content and emotion) • Understand a perspective on its own terms • Craft a cohesive and compelling narrative
Potential Mini-Module Pairings	• Introducing Inquiry Questions • Analyzing Audience: Pathos as Inquiry